

DI 1015: Non-Technical Course Module on Counselling
University of Moratuwa - Faculty of Information Technology

This module will be assessed through two assessments.

Assessment 01: Storyboard (Planning Stage)

Weight: 35% of total module marks

Type: Group Assessment (8 members per group)

Submission Date: 23 January 2026

Instructions

- Form groups of 6-8 members of your choice.
- Each group must fill the Google sheet with members' details before the due date.
- This assessment will **not be conducted individually**. Students who miss the scheduled submission will not be eligible for an individual assessment.
- All members must participate in the assessment and actively contribute to the storyboard development.
- Each group must submit a **Work Breakdown Sheet** that clearly outlines:
 - The specific tasks assigned to each member
 - How these tasks were carried out
 - A signed declaration by all group members confirming equal participation.

Task Description

Your group is required to **create a storyboard** that demonstrates how you would communicate awareness on an assigned counselling-related theme to a specific population or audience in Sri Lanka. The lecturers will assign one theme to each group from the following list:

No.	Theme	Population / Target Audience
1	Grief & loss after disasters	Survivors of landslides or floods
2	Impact of screen time on well-being	University students (ages 18 - 25)
3	Peer influence and substance addiction	Adolescents (ages 11 - 18)
4	Understanding sexual orientation	Parents and Caregivers (ages 40 - 55)
5	Importance of comprehensive sex education	Secondary School Teachers (Grades 6 - 11)
6	Watching pornography and pornography	University students (age 18 - 25)

	addiction	
7	Suicide awareness and prevention	Secondary School Teachers and Parents
8	Cultural silence around grief	Families in rural communities
9	Impact of alcohol addiction on families	Malaiyaha Tamil Communities
10	Social media misinformation about sexuality	Youth (ages 11 - 30)
11	Navigating sociocultural and legal expectations around homosexuality	Middle-aged adults living in Kandy (ages 40 - 60)
12	Dispelling myths about counselling	Community setting (mixed-aged groups)

Components of a storyboard

A storyboard helps you visualise and organise your awareness campaign before recording it. It should reflect both the message and emotional tone of your campaign.

To ensure clarity and engagement, structure your storyboard using the following arc:

1. **Opening:** Introduce the setting and relatable characters.
2. **Problem:** Show the social issue, misunderstanding or conflict.
3. **Turning point:** Present emotional or informational insight in line with counselling theories, approaches and techniques.
4. **Resolution:** Show the positive change(s) or action(s) taken.
5. **Call to action:** Encourage audience behaviour change.

Types of storyboards

Depending on your campaign's purpose, your storyboard can take different forms. You can choose whichever type best suits your group's skills and message:

1. Visual Storyboard

- Contains drawings, photos, AI visuals, and icons for each component.
- Tip: You don't need to be an artist - simple stick figures or digital icons work just fine.

2. Textual or Script-Based Storyboard

- Focuses on descriptions, dialogue, and narration without the use of pictures.

3. Hybrid Storyboard

- Combines visuals and text.

- One side shows the scene image or sketch, and the other side lists dialogue, key message, emotion, and learning objective.

Why Storyboarding Helps (Even Without Pictures)

Storyboarding helps you:

- Organise your message flow logically.
- Identify gaps, repetition, or unclear transitions.
- Clarify tone, timing, and emotional rhythm of your content.
- Communicate your campaign idea effectively to your team or lecturer.

Grading criteria

You will be graded on:

- Understanding of Issue & Audience - Clearly identifies the issue, shows a strong understanding of the target population, cultural context, and relevance. Demonstrates insight into psychosocial realities in Sri Lanka.
- Application of Counselling Theories & Skills - Accurate integration of counselling approaches (e.g., CBT, person-centred, grief models, addiction frameworks). Turning point reflects theory-based insight. Demonstrates ethical sensitivity.
- Storytelling Quality & Narrative Flow - Clear 5-step narrative arc; scenes connect logically; message is coherent, emotionally engaging, and impactful. Visual/text flow is easy to follow.
- Creativity & Communication Effectiveness - Innovative, original approach. Visuals, tone, and dialogue effectively deliver the message. Makes content easy to understand for the chosen audience.
- Collaboration & Professionalism - Evident equal participation, well-distributed tasks, timely communication, professionalism during presentation + complete Work Breakdown Sheet.

Sample Version:
Members

Group No.	Name of Members	Registration No.

Work distribution

Tasks	Member Involved	Signature

Assessment 02: Recorded Awareness Campaign (Delivery Stage)

Weight: 65% of total module marks

Type: Group Assessment (8 members per group)

Submission Date: 23 January 2026

Instructions

- Continue working in the same group of 6-8 members formed for Assessment 01.
- Your recorded video campaign should be based on the storyboard you submitted for Assessment 01.
- This assessment will not be conducted individually. All members must be physically visible in the video and must each present a part of the campaign.
- Each student must have **at least one speaking role**.
- All members must participate in planning, recording, and presenting the campaign. Participation may include acting, voice-over, video design, editing, directing, scriptwriting, or managing logistics.

Campaign Goals

Your recorded awareness campaign must demonstrate;

1. Awareness raising - improve audience understanding of the selected psychosocial issue among the target population.
2. Behavioural or Attitudinal change - encourage or introduce adaptive ways of thinking, coping or responding to the issue.
3. Psychosocial and counselling sensitivity - model or demonstrate counselling approaches and techniques such as empathy, listening, validation, psychoeducation, etc.
4. Cultural and ethical appropriateness - present the above information respectfully and culturally sensitive and appropriate within the Sri Lankan context.
5. Accessible communication - deliver your message in a way that is understandable, relatable, and meaningful to the assigned target audience.

These goals should be clearly visible in the narrative, dialogue, turning point, and call to action of your final recorded campaign.

Task Description

- Your group must create a 20-minute recorded awareness campaign video based on the same counselling-related theme and target population assigned in Assessment 01.
- All the members in the group should be physically visible on the campaign video. Each member should also have an individual part to present during that campaign.
- The video should communicate a clear, accurate, and culturally appropriate counselling awareness message to an identified Sri Lankan audience.
- The video should be in English.

Your video must:

1. Use the narrative arc from your storyboard (Opening → Problem → Turning Point → Resolution → Call to Action).
2. Demonstrate the use of at least one counselling theory, approach, or technique, such as:
 - Active listening
 - Empathy
 - Cognitive reframing (CBT)
 - Person-centred unconditional positive regard
 - Grief support principles
 - Psychoeducation
3. Use ethical, respectful, and non-stigmatising messaging.
4. End with a clear Call to Action, such as:
 - “Talk to a trusted adult or counsellor.”
 - “Help is available; reach out.”
 - “Choose healthy coping strategies.”
 - “Verify information before sharing.”
5. Ensure the video is understandable and relevant to the specific target audience (e.g., adolescents, parents, university students, rural families, teachers).

Format Options

Your group may choose any one of the following formats:

- Short dramatised skit or role-play
- Talk show
- Interview

Note: The focus is on *message clarity* and *counselling application*, not high-end video production. Mobile recordings and basic editing are acceptable.

Technical Requirements

- Duration: 20 minutes
- Format: Google Drive (upload as mp4)
- Language: English
- Editing Tools (optional): Canva, CapCut, InShot, PowerPoint exports, etc.

Submission Requirements

Each group must submit the following:

1. Final Video File (MP4) uploaded to Google Drive shared by the coordinator.
2. Storyboard
3. Work Breakdown Sheet signed by all members.

Grading Criteria

- Campaign Purpose, Issue Accuracy & Audience Relevance - The video demonstrates a clear, accurate understanding of the chosen psychosocial issue, using information that is age-appropriate, culturally appropriate, and relevant to the assigned Sri Lankan audience. The campaign purpose (awareness, behaviour change, destigmatisation) is explicit and strongly communicated.
- Application of Counselling Theories, Approaches & Skills - Counselling concepts (e.g., empathy, CBT reframing, person-centred warmth, psychoeducation, grief models, addiction frameworks) are accurately integrated into the turning point or resolution. Demonstrates ethical communication, avoids stereotyping, and models appropriate counsellor behaviour.
- Narrative Structure, Creativity & Communication Effectiveness - The campaign follows a strong narrative arc (Opening - Problem - Turning Point - Resolution - Call to Action). The storytelling is compelling, engaging, and emotionally impactful. Visuals, dialogue, pacing, and tone are clear, cohesive, and enhance understanding. Creativity is evident through original framing, scenario design, and message delivery.
- Technical Quality & Production Effort - Audio is clear, visuals are appropriate, scenes are easy to follow. Editing is clean and consistent (even if simple). The group demonstrates effort, organisation, and attention to detail in the final product. Technical flaws do not distract from meaning.
- Collaboration, Professionalism & Documentation - Work Breakdown Sheet clearly shows balanced contribution, professionalism, and shared responsibility. All members participate meaningfully. The group demonstrates respect, preparation, and smooth coordination.